chief spokesperson (who had legitimate reason to be talking about the Yatra). That made us all realize that no matter what the BJP said, the Congress was full of patriots driven by public service and idealism.

I believe that the Bharat Jodo Yatra has opened up an alternative path for the Indian National Congress. Unknowingly, it has galvanized the spirits of every worker of the Indian National Congress to work harder than ever before. I can only hope that the party leadership will take care of the aspirations of the yatris and Yatra organizers.

It has also positioned the Congress in contradistinction to the hyper-pseudo-nationalistic narrative of the current regime. The Yatra brought to light problems that ordinary Indians have been suffering for the past decade, including unemployment, the negative after-effects of crony capitalism, growing intolerance and hatred, and the growing gap between the rich and the poor, all of which have a detrimental and long-term impact on our country. The Yatra instilled the feeling in the hearts of ordinary Indians that even though the situation is bleak, it is not yet time to give up hope.

And finally, it is only because of Rahul Gandhi's perseverance that India has re-awakened to the truth that any progress that a nation can make is by remaining united while celebrating its diversities. India is akin to a good thali meal. What makes a thali meal taste good is not a single item in the thali but all the items combined. Similarly, it is only when all the diversities of India unite for a common goal that India will achieve its true potential.

When the history of these dark times is written sometime in the future, the Bharat Jodo Yatra will be considered a landmark event that changed the course of India for the better.